

Hvac Repair Quote Guide — Action Checklist

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VERIFY BEFORE YOU HIRE

- ☐ **Verify Before You Hire:** Request a written, line-item estimate from every HVAC contractor that breaks down labor costs, parts costs, markup percentage, and added fees so you can see exactly what you're paying for and spot inflated charges.
- ☐ **Verify Before You Hire:** Ask the contractor to explain each line item and confirm whether bundling multiple part replacements on one visit is actually necessary, because bundling is a common way contractors pad invoices with unnecessary parts.
- ☐ **Verify Before You Hire:** Take a photo of the nameplate on your outdoor unit to capture model and serial numbers, then search for part numbers on SupplyHouse.com or Amazon to verify the contractor's quoted prices are within 40% of retail.
- ☐ **Verify Before You Hire:** Apply the repair versus replace decision tree by checking your system's age and comparing the quote against the threshold amounts, since repairing systems over 12 years old often costs more than replacement in the long run.

GET COMPETITIVE BIDS

- ☐ **Get Competitive Bids:** Call at least 3 HVAC companies and use the exact competitive quote script by saying you've received a quote for a specific problem and are gathering two more bids before deciding to pressure-test the first estimate.
- ☐ **Get Competitive Bids:** Invoke the 72-hour rule immediately by telling any contractor you need three days to review their estimate and compare options, because any company pressuring you to sign same-day is using urgency as a control tactic.
- ☐ **Get Competitive Bids:** Ask each company the five essential screening questions covering state licensing, diagnostic fees, written estimates, whether they use employees or subcontractors, and warranty coverage on labor and parts before scheduling.

- **Get Competitive Bids:** Find vetted local contractors by using Angie's List or HomeAdvisor's licensed contractor filter, setting a minimum 5-star rating with at least 10 reviews, and cross-referencing recommendations in your neighborhood Facebook group or Nextdoor.

KNOW FAIR REPAIR COSTS

- **Know Fair Repair Costs:** Memorize the fair price range for common repairs including run/start capacitors at \$90–\$200, contactors at \$75–\$180, and blower motors at \$350–\$900 so you can immediately identify quotes that are grossly inflated.
- **Know Fair Repair Costs:** Research refrigerant R-410A pricing at \$75–\$150 per pound knowing most residential systems need 5–15 pounds for a total material cost of \$375–\$2,250 installed, because refrigerant charges are frequently inflated on quotes.
- **Know Fair Repair Costs:** Flag any quote where parts are marked up more than 40% above retail prices found on supply websites, because excessive markup is a red flag for a company that prioritizes profit over fair customer pricing.
- **Know Fair Repair Costs:** Treat same-visit upsells with skepticism by asking for a separate diagnostic appointment when a technician identifies three or more additional problems during one service call, because legitimate emergency repairs rarely come with multiple urgent add-ons.

Companion to the full guide in your Lemon Squeezy library — check off each item as you complete it.